
Flower Dedication

The flowers are given today by Laurin and Waring Porter to celebrate the baptism of their granddaughter, Charlotte Mae Porter, and in gratitude for this congregation’s sustaining prayers.

“He has done great things for us and we are filled with joy!” — Psalm 126:3

Announcements

The Red Rose welcomes Timothy “Archie” Bucknor, born on July 10 to Mary Liddon Archie and Judson Bucknor. The proud grandparents are Shellie and Les Archie.

Men’s Intensive 3 Is Coming! *A Better Way to Live* — Aug 13–Sep 24. Registration is now open. A 7-week commitment to show up on 7 Thursdays at 6 a.m. for 7 conversations with 7 other men you should know but may not.



Scan for info

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dr. Steve Blair

Greeters — Brent & Mollie Johnson

Acolytes — Madelyn Whittington & Kathryn Moore

Ushers — Nate Alexander, Billy Scott Blackwelder, Bob Moore, Brian Thomas, & Spencer Lee

Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Penny Long, Suzanne Davis, Tara Mathis, & Jeannie Blackwelder

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor

Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship

Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care

Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries

Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director

Jan Pike - Choir Director

Malachi Doren - Accompanist

Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant

Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

July 22 Kids Quest Parent Meeting, 5:30 p.m. · Fellowship Hall

July 22 Youth House Parent Meeting, 6:15 p.m. · Youth House

July 26 Rally Day

July 27 First Day of School (Corinth) · Back to School Prayer, 8 a.m. at the Pavilion

July 29 Luncheon at Pizza Grocery, 11:30 a.m. — empty-nesters and up

August 2 Session Meeting

August 9 Deacons’ Meeting

August 10 Youth Bible Studies Restart

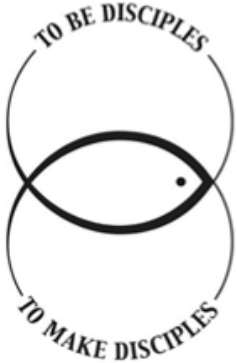
August 13 MI3 Begins

August 14–15 Officer Spouse Retreat

Online Giving



Scan to give online



First Presbyterian Church

July 19, 2026

Eighth Sunday after Pentecost

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children’s Church — Individual members of our congregation are leading “A Word for the Children” during the month of July after the offertory. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. Children are always welcome in worship!

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Tears and Triumph”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 3:8–13

God’s people have returned from seventy years of exile. The altar has been rebuilt, sacrifices have resumed, and now the foundation of the Temple is finally being laid. This should be a day of pure celebration. Instead, Ezra tells us something surprising. Some people shout for joy. Others weep aloud. The sounds become so intertwined that no one standing at a distance can tell one from the other. Perhaps you’ve experienced moments like that. Life with God often refuses to fit into simple emotional categories. This passage reminds us that God’s restoring work often produces grief over what has been lost and hope for what He has promised. Those emotions are not enemies. In fact, they often exist together in the hearts of God’s people.

I. Begins with the Right Foundation (vv. 8–10)

II. Makes Room for Both Tears and Triumph (vv. 11–13)

“Rejoice with those who rejoice, weep with those who weep.” — Romans 12:15

III. There Is a Greater Glory (Haggai 2:3–9)

“Jesus answered them, ‘Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.’” — John 2:19
“I will build My church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.” — Matthew 16:18

WORD	
Story of Grace	<i>RYM Summer Conference Keller Roach & Ivy Monaghan</i>
The Giving of Tithes and Offerings	
The Offertory	<i>“Be Thou My Vision” Malachi Doren, piano; Paige Frame, flute</i>
*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication <i>Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.</i>	
A Word for the Children	<i>Randy Long</i>
Scripture Reading <i>Ezra 3:8–13 · Pew Bible, p. 390</i>	
Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8 Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field; <i>All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.</i>	
Sermon: <i>“Restored by Grace: Tears and Triumph”</i> <i>Rev. Waring Porter</i>	
Prayer of Commitment	

SENDING

*Hymn: #276	<i>“Christ Is Made the Sure Foundation” (vv. 1, 4)</i>
*Benediction	
*Postlude	

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD	
July 19, 2026	
* Indicates congregation standing if able	
GATHERING	
The Piano Prelude	
Greetings & Announcements	
Call to Meditation: Psalm 42:5	
“Hope in God, for I shall again praise him, my salvation and my God.”	
The Prelude	
*Call to Worship: Psalm 30:1–5	CALL TO WORSHIP We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth. Worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.
Leader: I will extol you, O Lord, for you have drawn me up and have not let my foes rejoice over me. O Lord my God, I cried to you for help, and you have healed me.	
All: O Lord, you have brought up my soul from Sheol; you restored me to life from among those who go down to the pit.	
Leader: Sing praises to the Lord, O you his saints, and give thanks to his holy name. For his anger is but for a moment, and his favor is for a lifetime.	
All: Weeping may tarry for the night, but joy comes with the morning.	
Leader: Let us worship the Lord.	
*The Hymn: #275	“How Firm a Foundation”

INVOCATION
The word “invocation” suggests that the congregation calls upon God, yet this must not be misunderstood to mean that we bring God into our presence or that His nearness depends on our request. The Lord is already present with His people before our worship begins. To “invoke” is to call upon or earnestly seek. So, we lift our voices to God, asking Him to draw near and enable us to worship Him rightly for His character and mighty works.

*Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

*The Old Testament Reading: Haggai 2:3–9

““Who is left among you who saw this house in its former glory? How do you see it now? Is it not as nothing in your eyes? Yet now be strong, O Zerubbabel, declares the Lord. Be strong, O Joshua, son of Jehozadak, the high priest. Be strong, all you people of the land, declares the Lord. Work, for I am with you, declares the Lord of hosts, according to the covenant that I made with you when you came out of Egypt. My Spirit remains in your midst. Fear not. For thus says the Lord of hosts: Yet once more, in a little while, I will shake the heavens and the earth and the sea and the dry land. And I will shake all nations, so that the treasures of all nations shall come in, and I will fill this house with glory, says the Lord of hosts. The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, declares the Lord of hosts. The latter glory of this house shall be greater than the former, says the Lord of hosts. And in this place I will give peace, declares the Lord of hosts.””

HYMN OF RESPONSE
This verse invites the congregation to respond in faith to Haggai’s word from the Lord, and reinforces a central biblical truth: God’s people may experience genuine sorrow over present weakness while resting confidently in the Lord’s abiding presence and His future purposes.

*Hymn of Response: “It Is Well With My Soul” (v. 1)

When peace like a river attendeth my way, When sorrows like sea billows roll; Whatever my lot, Thou hast taught me to say, It is well, it is well with my soul. It is well (It is well), With my soul (With my soul); It is well, it is well, with my soul.

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Merciful Father, we confess that we are too often discouraged by what we see rather than strengthened by what You have promised. We compare the present to the past, trust our own judgment more than Your Word, and forget that You are faithfully accomplishing Your purposes in Your perfect time. Forgive us for doubting Your presence and for failing to rest in Your covenant promises. Renew our faith by Your Holy Spirit, that we may rejoice in Your work, serve You with steadfast hearts, and fix our hope on Christ, whose glory far surpasses all earthly glory. We ask this in His holy name.

Silent Confession

*Assurance of Divine Pardon: Romans 8:1; 1 Peter 2:24

“There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus. He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we might die to sin and live to righteousness. By his wounds you have been healed.”

ASSURANCE OF PARDON
After confessing our sins, we hear God’s promise of forgiveness, reminding us that the good news of Jesus Christ meets our confession with grace. We are reminded that true repentance is always answered by God’s faithful forgiveness, and Christ’s saving work is greater than our sin.

*Gloria Patri

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son: and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

THE SACRAMENT OF BAPTISM

Sacrament of Infant Baptism

*Charlotte Mae Porter
Daughter of Alex & Kayla Porter*

INFANT BAPTISM
We believe infant baptism is a sign and seal of God’s covenant of grace, marking the children of believers as members of the visible church just as circumcision did under the old covenant. It does not guarantee salvation, but it signifies God’s promises and calls the child to personal faith and repentance as they grow. (Gen. 17:7–12; Col. 2:11–12)

*Song of Blessing: “Jesus Loves You”

Jesus loves you, this we know, for the Bible tells us so; Little ones to Him belong, you are weak but He is strong. Yes, Jesus loves you! Yes, Jesus loves you! Yes, Jesus loves you! The Bible tells us so.